

ENDGAME AND AFTERMATH

AFTER JANUARY 1973

The departure of American forces did not end the war in Vietnam. Despite an official ceasefire, fighting continued between the ARVN and communist troops. In America, the political will to support the Saigon government rapidly evaporated. Realizing the United States would not intervene, North Vietnam embarked upon a final offensive in spring 1975. The last American personnel were evacuated from Saigon as NVA tanks entered the city. Vietnam was then reunited under a hardline communist regime. Meanwhile, Cambodia fell to the communist Khmer Rouge, its population suffering immense hardship. Vietnam fought further wars against the Khmer Rouge and China before a kind of peace prevailed. In America, the process of coming to terms with the war and its consequences was painful and prolonged.